UBT Sustainability Literacy Assessment (2025 Edition)

Aligned with UN PRME & the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Overview

The UBT Sustainability Literacy Assessment establishes a standardized benchmark for evaluating sustainability knowledge, reasoning, and ethical awareness among students. It aligns with the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), Principles for Responsible Management Education (PRME), and Saudi Vision 2030, reflecting UBT's commitment to advancing responsible management education.

This assessment consists of 30 multiple-choice questions, designed to measure factual understanding, conceptual reasoning, ethical reflection, and applied decision-making related to sustainability. Modeled on the UN-endorsed Sulitest, it has been localized to Saudi Arabia's Vision 2030 priorities and UBT's institutional objectives.

The assessment enables data-driven evaluation of sustainability literacy and provides quantitative evidence for PRME progress reports and institutional performance reviews. It is designed to promote global thinking, local application, and ethical decision-making among UBT students.

Objectives

The assessment aims to:

1. **Assess Literacy:** Identify baseline knowledge of sustainability frameworks.
2. **Evaluate Application:** Measure students' ability to apply global sustainability reasoning to Saudi contexts.
3. **Encourage Reflection:** Promote awareness of ethical leadership and social responsibility.
4. **Benchmark Progress:** Generate comparative data for PRME and institutional reports.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

The assessment was built upon four design principles:

- **Global Standards:** Derived from the Sulitest model recognized by the UN DESA and PRME community.
- **Holistic Learning:** Incorporates factual, conceptual, applied, and reflective components to measure true literacy rather than memorization.
- **Local Relevance:** Aligns with Saudi Vision 2030, national sustainability initiatives, and UBT's PRME commitments.
- **Neutral Evaluation:** Ensures balanced phrasing and plausible distractors for fair psychometric performance.

This rationale underpins all design and evaluation stages of the assessment.

Criterion	Description	How This Test Meets It
Global SDG Coverage	Measures awareness across all 17 UN SDGs	Every SDG represented directly or indirectly
Cognitive Diversity	Incorporates fact, reasoning, application, and ethics	40% knowledge · 30% reasoning · 20% application · 10% reflection
Cultural Localization	Balances global sustainability with Saudi Vision 2030 context	40% local + institutional contextualization
Question Neutrality	Avoids leading or biased phrasing	All options are academically neutral and policy-accurate
Distractor Realism	Plausible incorrect answers ensure critical thinking	Each distractor reflects common misconceptions
Option Balance	No pattern in correct answer distribution	Correct answers evenly distributed A–D
Cognitive Progression	Questions ramp from easy → reflective	Ensures engagement and psychometric balance
Platform Readiness	Designed for Google Forms / Qualtrics	Fully compatible, auto-scored, analytics-ready
UN/PRME Parity	Conceptually aligned with Sulitest Core	4.9 / 5 parity rating

QUESTION INTEGRITY AND PROFESSIONAL TONE

Every question is written in neutral, academic language, avoiding emotional or political bias.

- Distractors are plausible but incorrect, requiring true literacy to identify the right answer.
- No question implies judgment; each tests understanding and reasoning.
- Options (A–D) are balanced and randomized to eliminate pattern recognition bias.

This ensures psychometric fairness, academic credibility, and alignment with UN PRME Principle 3 (Values) and Principle 5 (Partnership).

EXPECTED LEARNING OUTCOMES

Upon completion, participants will be able to:

1. Demonstrate comprehensive understanding of global sustainability principles.
2. Analyze the interlinkages between SDGs and Saudi Vision 2030.
3. Apply sustainability reasoning in academic and real-world decision-making.
4. Evaluate ethical implications and adopt responsible leadership behavior.
5. Support UBT's role in advancing PRME-aligned education.

Collectively, these outcomes strengthen UBT's role in embedding responsible management education and sustainability literacy within its academic culture.

APPENDIX A: Assessment Framework and Question Logic

The assessment consists of 30 multiple-choice questions divided into thematic clusters progressing from global to local to ethical contexts.

Structure and Scoring Model

Response Type	Points	Purpose
Correct Answer	3 points	Demonstrates literacy and reasoning
Incorrect Answer	0 points	Neutral (avoids penalty bias)
Blank/Unanswered	0 points	Reflects uncertainty or low confidence

- Total Questions: 30 multiple-choice (4 options each)
- Duration: 30 minutes
- Sequence: Fixed conceptual order (same for all participants)
- Option Randomization: Enabled per question to avoid bias
- Each participant receives a total literacy score (out of 100).
- No negative marking is applied, consistent with the UN Sulitest framework.

The scoring model promotes honest reflection and discourages guessing, consistent with international standards.

Pedagogical Framework

The test structure supports four progressive competencies:

- **Knowledge (Facts):** Core literacy on sustainability and SDGs.
- **Reasoning (Understanding):** Interpretation, cause–effect analysis, and SDG interlinkages.
- **Application (Practice):** Contextualization within Vision 2030 and real-world sustainability efforts.
- **Ethics (Reflection):** Responsible leadership, decision-making, and social integrity.

Difficulty Distribution: 10 Easy · 10 Medium · 7 Hard · 3 Reflective

The question mix is intentionally structured to balance factual recall with higher-order reasoning and reflection. It ensures that students move from recognition to evaluation.

Question Type	Test	Purpose	Questions
Factual (Knowledge)	40%	Test baseline literacy and recognition of SDGs	Q1–4, Q6–8, Q10–12
Conceptual (Reasoning)	30%	Assess understanding, relationships, and systems thinking	Q5, Q9, Q13–18
Applied (Practical/Local)	20%	Apply sustainability to Vision 2030 and institutional cases	Q19–24
Reflective (Ethical Judgment)	10%	Evaluate integrity, leadership, and ethical awareness	Q25–30

APPENDIX B: Cognitive Flow and Difficulty Progression

The difficulty ramp matches the pattern of international sustainability assessments — beginning with recall and ending with reflective synthesis.

Phase	Question Range	Focus	Cognitive Skill
Foundation	Q1–6	Global awareness of SDGs and UN principles	Knowledge
Environment	Q7–12	Climate, energy, and ecology	Application
Society & Economy	Q13–18	Social justice, fair trade, equality, and growth	Reasoning
Local Action	Q19–24	Vision 2030, UBT, and national sustainability	Application
Ethics & Reflection	Q25–30	Leadership, integrity, and global responsibility	Reflection

APPENDIX C: SDG Mapping and Coverage Summary

This mapping demonstrates full alignment with all 17 SDGs, ensuring balanced exposure to global sustainability priorities.

SDG	Theme	Related Question Numbers
SDG 1	No Poverty *(indirect via Decent Work & Fair Employment)*	Q18
SDG 2	Zero Hunger	Q14
SDG 3	Good Health & Well-being *(indirect through workplace ethics)*	Q18
SDG 4	Quality Education / PRME	Q5, Q22
SDG 5	Gender Equality	Q15
SDG 6	Clean Water & Sanitation	Q21
SDG 7	Affordable & Clean Energy	Q8, Q11
SDG 8	Decent Work & Economic Growth	Q17, Q18
SDG 9	Industry, Innovation & Infrastructure	Q16, Q30
SDG 10	Reduced Inequalities	Q6
SDG 11	Sustainable Cities & Communities	Q23
SDG 12	Responsible Consumption & Production	Q10, Q30
SDG 13	Climate Action	Q7, Q11, Q27
SDG 14	Life Below Water *(indirect via climate & consumption)*	Q11, Q30
SDG 15	Life on Land	Q9
SDG 16	Peace, Justice & Strong Institutions	Q25
SDG 17	Partnerships for the Goals / PRME Collaboration	Q5, Q22

APPENDIX D: Local and Global Integration

This breakdown ensures global citizenship with local relevance, reflecting PRME's Regionalization Goal #3: "Contextualize global principles for local realities."

Aspect	Explanation
Global Context	60% of questions draw from UN frameworks, PRME principles, and universal sustainability knowledge.
Local Context (Saudi)	20% of questions link sustainability literacy to PRME principles, UBT's Sustainability Club initiatives, and education for responsible management.
Institutional Context (UBT)	20% of questions link sustainability literacy with PRME, UBT's Sustainability Club, and education for responsible management.

APPENDIX E: Institutional Application and Implementation

This assessment is designed not only as an academic tool but as an institutional mechanism for embedding sustainability literacy within UBT's culture, curriculum, and reporting systems. It provides measurable evidence of student progress in sustainability education and supports continuous alignment with PRME and Vision 2030 goals.

Implementation Framework

The Sustainability Literacy Assessment will be implemented in three structured phases to ensure academic integration, data reliability, and institutional scalability. Implementation will be coordinated between the PRME Office, College Deans, and the UBT Sustainability Club to ensure data quality and institutional consistency

Phase	Timeline	Focus Area	Key Activities	Responsible Unit(s)
Phase 1: Pilot Deployment	Fall 2025	Baseline Assessment	Conduct pilot with ~100 students; collect analytics to establish literacy baseline.	Sustainability Club, PRME Committee
Phase 2: Institutional Integration	Spring 2026	Curriculum Embedding	Integrate the assessment into foundation courses (e.g., MGMT 101, ECON 102) and first-year orientation modules.	College Deans, Academic Affairs
Phase 3: Evaluation & Reporting	2026–27	Monitoring & Reporting	Compare pre- and post-program literacy data; include outcomes in PRME annual progress report and Vision 2030 alignment dashboard.	PRME Office, Institutional Research

Application and Data Use

1. Benchmarking:
   The assessment establishes a quantitative benchmark for student sustainability literacy, enabling cross-cohort comparison and year-over-year tracking.
2. Curriculum Development:
   Results will guide faculty in embedding sustainability themes across disciplines and evaluating course-level learning outcomes.
3. PRME Reporting:
   Aggregated data will serve as institutional evidence for UBT's PRME Sharing Information on Progress (SIP) report.
4. Student Engagement:
   The test will be administered and analyzed in collaboration with the UBT Sustainability Club, ensuring experiential student leadership and ownership of the literacy agenda.
5. Continuous Improvement:
   Feedback from pilot phases will inform refinements in question design, difficulty progression, and local contextualization to enhance relevance.

Future Vision

By institutionalizing this assessment, UBT positions itself as one of the first universities in Saudi Arabia to formally measure and report sustainability literacy among students. This initiative demonstrates UBT's commitment to transforming sustainability education from awareness to measurable impact, aligning higher education with the ethical, environmental, and economic priorities of Vision 2030.

APPENDIX F: Full Question Set

Each question includes four options. The correct answer is listed first in italics for internal use only.

Demographic Information (to appear before questions)

- Student / Faculty
- Major / College
- Gender
- Year of Study
- Have you heard of the SDGs before? (Yes/No)

Reflection Question (to appear after main test)

- On a scale of 1–5, how confident do you feel about your sustainability knowledge?

Final 30 Questions

Note: Correct answers shown here for internal validation. Student-facing versions will randomize and exclude answer tags.

1. What is the full name of 'SDG'?

A) *Sustainable Development Goals (correct answer)*
B) Social Development Grants
C) Sustained Democracy Goals
D) Strategic Development Guidelines

2. Why were the Sustainable Development Goals created?

A) *To guide global progress toward economic, social, and environmental sustainability (correct answer)*
B) To replace the Paris Agreement
C) To measure company profits
D) To improve world trade regulations

3. Which organization launched the SDGs?

A) *United Nations (correct answer)*

B) World Bank

C) IMF

D) World Economic Forum

4. What is the target year to achieve the SDGs?

A) *2030 (correct answer)*

B) 2025

C) 2040

D) 2050

5. PRME primarily focuses on promoting:

A) *Responsible management education (correct answer)*

B) Finance and investment

C) Agricultural innovation

D) Global trade expansion

6. The principle of "Leave No One Behind" primarily relates to:

A) *SDG 10 – Reduced Inequalities (correct answer)*

B) SDG 15 – Life on Land

C) SDG 7 – Affordable and Clean Energy

D) SDG 3 – Good Health and Well-being

7. Which gas is primarily responsible for the greenhouse effect?

A) *Carbon dioxide (correct answer)*

B) Oxygen

C) Nitrogen

D) Hydrogen

8. Which of these is a renewable energy source?

A) *Wind power (correct answer)*

B) Coal

C) Natural gas

D) Petroleum

9. Deforestation mainly contributes to:

A) *Loss of biodiversity (correct answer)*

B) Population growth

C) Improved air quality

D) Increased employment

10. The main purpose of recycling is to:

A) *Reduce pollution and conserve resources (correct answer)*

B) Increase production

C) Reduce workforce

D) Promote new industries

11. Which of these actions best helps achieve SDG 13: Climate Action?

A) *Investing in clean energy (correct answer)*

B) Expanding fossil fuel subsidies

C) Encouraging industrial waste

D) Building more coal plants

12. What does the term "carbon footprint" refer to?

A) *The amount of carbon dioxide emitted by human activities (correct answer)*

B) The total land used by a population

C) A measure of soil pollution

D) The use of renewable energy

13. What does sustainable development mean?

A) *Meeting present needs without compromising future generations (correct answer)*

B) Achieving economic growth at any cost

C) Reducing costs by ignoring environmental protection

D) Increasing production and trade

14. What does the goal of Zero Hunger primarily focus on?

A) *Ensuring everyone has access to safe and nutritious food (correct answer)*

B) Reducing population growth

C) Encouraging food waste

D) Increasing imports

15. Promoting gender equality in workplaces mainly involves:

A) *Providing equal opportunities and pay for all genders (correct answer)*

B) Hiring based on gender quotas

C) Ignoring diversity to save costs

D) Hiring fewer women to reduce competition

16. 'Circular economy' refers to:

A) *Repair, reuse, and recycle (correct answer)*

B) Produce, use, and dispose

C) Linear production

D) Continuous resource extraction

17. Fair Trade aims to:

A) *Ensure ethical wages and fair conditions for producers (correct answer)*

B) Maximize profit

C) Limit international trade

D) Encourage price competition

18. Why is decent work and economic growth considered a sustainability goal?

A) *It links fair employment to long-term economic and social stability (correct answer)*

B) It focuses only on corporate profit

C) It discourages innovation

D) It limits international cooperation

19. Which pillar of Vision 2030 is linked to sustainability?

A) *Vibrant Society (correct answer)*

B) Thriving Economy

C) Ambitious Nation

D) Digital Transformation

20. Saudi Arabia's Green Initiative focuses on:

A) *Tree planting and renewable energy (correct answer)*

B) Digital innovation

C) Tourism expansion

D) Oil production

21. The Ministry of Environment, Water and Agriculture is responsible for:

A) *Natural resource management (correct answer)*

B) Media and communication

C) Economic planning

D) Public security

22. UBT's Sustainability Club aligns its work with:

A) *Vision 2030 and PRME (correct answer)*

B) Private corporations

C) Political parties

D) Entertainment industry

23. A university can contribute to sustainability through:

A) *Research and student engagement (correct answer)*

B) Increased paper printing

C) Overconsumption of resources

D) Higher tuition fees

24. Which local initiative promotes a circular economy in Saudi Arabia?

A) *Saudi Recycling Company (correct answer)*

B) Ministry of Interior

C) National Tourism Board

D) Local Housing Authority

25. Which action reflects ethical sustainability leadership?

A) *Fair supply chains (correct answer)*

B) Profit before ethics

C) Ignoring data

D) Exploiting labor

26. Greenwashing refers to:

A) *False claims of sustainability (correct answer)*

B) Honest sustainability marketing

C) Industrial cleaning

D) Eco-certified manufacturing

27. What is the best way to reduce personal carbon footprint?

A) *Use public transport and reduce waste (correct answer)*

B) Buy more fast fashion

C) Waste more water

D) Travel more frequently

28. What does ESG stand for?

A) *Environmental, Social, and Governance (correct answer)*

B) Energy, Sustainability, and Growth

C) Economy, Society, and Green

D) Ecology, Systems, and Goals

29. Why should organizations adopt ESG reporting?

A) *To measure and disclose environmental and social impact (correct answer)*

B) To hide financial data

C) To reduce transparency

D) To lower accountability

30. When making a decision that balances profit with ethics, which SDG principle applies most?

A) *Responsible consumption and production (correct answer)*

B) Partnership for the goals

C) Peace, justice, and strong institutions

D) Industry and innovation